

Pentax K-1

Pentax has finally delivered what it had promised a year back. After unveiling a prototype, the company launched the K-1, their first full-frame camera and has priced it substantially lower than the competition's offerings. It'll set you back by about ₹1.2 lacs while similarly specced full frames from competition will be about ₹1.5lacs. What does Pentax's full frame camera offer? The 36.4 MP sensor has a maximum sensitivity of 204,800 ISO and a maximum shooting speed of 4.4 fps, so you can expect great detail and dynamic range. The full-frame sensor is enclosed inside a dustproof, weather-resistant and cold-resistant magnesium alloy body which gives you 5-axis stabilisation. It also gives you a close to 100% field of view through the viewfinder. Another interesting feature of the K-1 is its weird 3.2-inch LCD screen mounted on four legs sliding across a series of slots. This makes it quite useful while taking those crazy shots that could give someone a backache. The body also consists of LED lights on the back to shed light on the controls and also above the lens mount to help you swap lenses in the dark. Not only did they announce a new camera but two lenses as well – the HD Pentax-D



FA15-30mm f/2.8 ultra-wide angle zoom and the HD Pentax-D FA 28-105mm f/3.5-5.6 compact zoom lens. Pentax has already been selling full-frame lenses for a while but the older ones don't have stabilisation and autofocus, so you'll have to wait for the new ones to arrive.



ThingMaker

Mattel has joined hands with Autodesk to give us the ThingMaker – an easy to use 3D printer to print out toys for kids. This is another step towards making 3D printing mainstream and not restricted to enthusiasts. You can print out all sorts of figurines and accessories using the ThingMaker Design App. The figurines follow a ball and socket design and the app contains an entire library of parts. You begin with a selection of stock figures followed by the liberty to swap and add any combination of parts. One can simply go crazy here by attaching human hands to a dinosaur's body or attaching wings to the dinosaur. Currently the ecosystem of the parts are quite generic and the company will eventually expand their library to include popular character from their franchises. The price tag of around ₹21k might sound attractive for parents wanting to experiment with 3D printing at home to make toys for their kids. Albeit, the entire process of designing your toy and printing may have been dumbed down extensively, kids will still need supervision. Mattel has incorporated several safety measures to ensure you or your kids don't hurt yourselves. The automated door locks itself up while printing, removing any possibility of irresponsible poking into the print area. At the end of a printing session, the heated print head retracts inside so that your hands don't accidentally come in contact while removing the printed toy.